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2019 Rockwall

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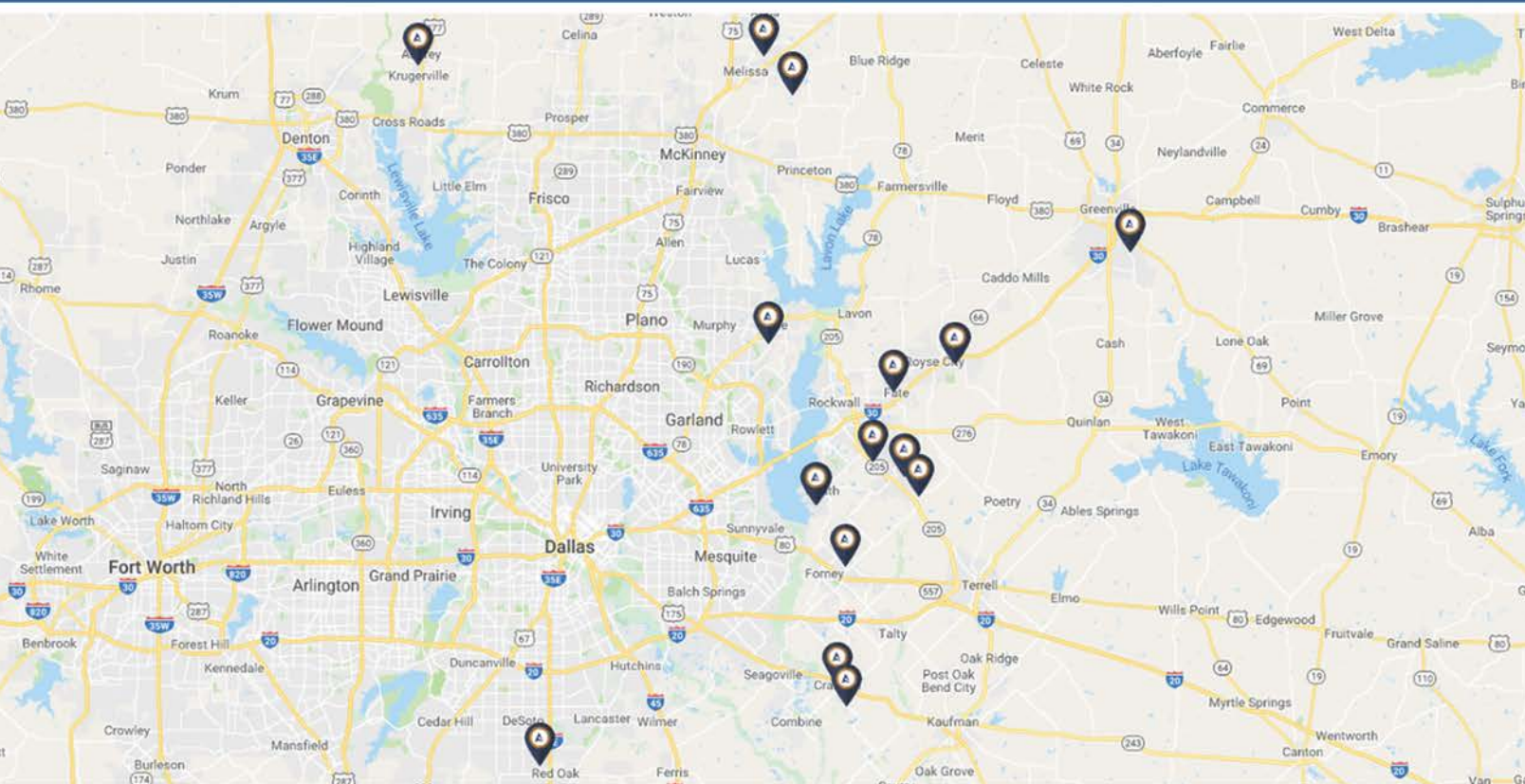
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Jerry Welch



The Welch Team



When introduced, I tell people I am a FULL TIME, PROFESSIONAL REALTOR®. Why do I specify Full Time, Professional? Because unlike many REALTORS® this is my fulltime profession and single source of income. I emphasize PROFESSIONAL because I have been a REALTOR® for over 12 years and was in the telecommunications industry for over 30 years before starting my real estate career.

My first year with Ebby I achieved their top “Star” level and have been a Top Producer every year since. I was voted as the “New & Emerging Business of the Year in 2015” by the Rockwall Chamber of Commerce.

Texas has over 500,000 real estate agents. So, you might ask, what makes me different than the other 499,999. Good question! My response is - the 3 items below:

BACKGROUND

Prior to real estate I spent over 30 years in the corporate world of telecommunications. During that time, I successfully managed numerous multi-million dollars accounts, all of which demanded exceptional customer service. Professionalism and responsiveness are two other attributes I brought with me.

EDUCATION

After acquiring my real estate licenses, I continue to pursue additional training. To date I have over 362 hours of post licenses certified training. This helps me enhance my skills in special areas in order to better serve my clients and their unique needs.

TECHNOLOGY

Coming from a telecommunication background, I have always sought to keep up with the latest technology. This, combined with the power of Ebby’s technology departments, allows me to provide my clients with state-of-the-art services.

Looking to buy a home in the Rockwall area? Check out our website www.TheWelchTeam.com and click on “Rockwall Searches” where you can easily search by Elementary school, sub-division and many others special requirements.

On the personal side; my wife of 45+ years and I moved to Rockwall from Plano in 2013 to be closer to our only daughter and son-in-law, but mainly our two grandkids – Brady 8 and Landry 6. Since moving to Rockwall, I have had the opportunity to go through the Citizens Police Academy, Citizens Fire Academy and Leadership Rockwall - Class of 2016. Currently I serve as a commissioner on Rockwall’s Planning and Zoning, chaired the Rockwall “Our Hometown Vision 2040 Comprehensive Plan” and am on several local non-profit boards. My wife and I are actively involved in Lake Pointe Church.



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Rockwall Area Chamber of Commerce 2019 Community Guide and Partner Directory

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Welcome



2019 marks the start of a yearlong celebration of our 90th year!

When I reflect on what previous leaders set forth to accomplish many years ago, I feel certain they would be proud of the body of work The Rockwall Area Chamber of Commerce is presenting these days.

In addition to regular Chamber activity, we now have five thriving affiliate groups: Leadership Rockwall, Professional

Women's Alliance, Rockwall Veteran's Business Alliance, Senior Services Alliance and Young Professionals of Rockwall. Each group is making their own special mark in our community.

The year 2018 saw some new beginnings for our Chamber. One addition is the Growth Group concept, developed by Tim Nichols. This program has gained much momentum and I know

will see continued success in 2019. Another significant change was the announcement of my promotion to President/CEO. I could not be more honored to get to work with such a talented board and staff. A community's success metrics can be linked to how well the business community is doing. We are so fortunate to have a grand list of flourishing businesses in our area that make our quality of life second to none. As a native of Rockwall, I have a vested interest in our community and the well-being of the business climate here. I am happy to report that Rockwall continues to rate as one of the metroplex's best areas to work, live and play.

This is a testament to our national, state, county and city leaders. We are fortunate to work side by side with the distinct mission of "Making Every Day Extraordinary for Business While Maintaining the Ideal Hometown Feel."

I want to sincerely thank our Board of Directors, Ambassadors, Growth Group leaders, committee participants, staff and all of our partners for the many ways that you continue to enrich the Chamber and Rockwall area.

Best wishes for a successful year!

Darby Burkey
President & CEO



Photo by Jack Palmer



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2019 Board of Directors



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PHOTO BY: KIMBERLY WORSHAM

Lorilee Litherland is a familiar face around Rockwall County thanks to her brightly wrapped Jeep Wrangler, but it's her love of helping clients navigate the process of selling or buying their largest investment that resonates most with the community. A Marine Corps veteran with a corporate management background in technical training and development, Lorilee obtained her real estate license in 2007. With a quick rise to success, including earning Coldwell Banker Apex's Rookie of the Year award, she has been a top-producing agent ever since.

Lorilee is fiercely dedicated to serving her client's best interests. Her renowned negotiation skills, meticulous attention to detail, proactive communication, and concierge style service set her apart as a leader in her field. As an individual agent, she is a clients' single point of contact, overseeing every detail of the transaction. Since her clients are never handed off to an assistant or less-experienced agent, she is able to develop

deep relationships and high levels of trust. Her clients know she is truly personally invested in making their dreams become a reality.

Lorilee is skilled in working with incoming and outgoing relocations, active military and veteran buyers, new construction, farm and ranch and luxury properties. International buyers benefit from her firsthand knowledge of the complexity of international moves, having lived in Sweden and England herself. She also actively seeks out continuing education courses to stay up to date on market changes and new technology. She holds a number of niche certifications, including Smart Home Technology, Certified Residential Specialist, Accredited Buyers Representative, Senior Real Estate Specialist and Certified Negotiation Specialist.

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Letter From the Mayor



WELCOME TO ROCKWALL!

It's no secret that the City of Rockwall is a great place to live, work and play, and as a City Council, we strive to help ensure it stays that way for years to come. Rockwall is sought after by people from miles around for its premier residential and commercial developments. We work to foster a

business-friendly environment with a dynamic quality of life in our rapidly growing lakeside community.

We're proud to announce that state legislators have recognized Rockwall as a *Free Live Music Capital of North Texas!* The City is the destination for live music, with more than 150 live music events each year drawing fans from far and wide—to beautiful outdoor venues such as the Founders Day Festival at Harry Myers Park, the San Jacinto Plaza Music Series in Historic Downtown Rockwall, and the Concert by the Lake Series at The Harbor on Lake Ray Hubbard. Now we have the official name to prove it.

Rockwall's continued growth is always a hot topic, and topping the list is usually The Harbor. I am happy to report the new owner has big plans for the area. PegasusAblon, is responsible for much of the innovative development within the Design District in Downtown Dallas. The developer's plans to revitalize The Harbor include attracting new entertainment-focused tenants to help transform the important business district.

Also crucial to the City's economic vitality, Downtown Rockwall has become a destination for residents and visitors alike. The \$8.625 million voter-approved bond project, completed in 2016, created the distinctive San Jacinto Plaza for unique outdoor gatherings. Overall, the renovations have made Downtown Rockwall more visitor and pedestrian friendly, and produced an atmosphere to help existing businesses thrive, while attracting new investments in dining, shopping and professional service opportunities in the area.

Another topic always under discussion is road

construction. While I know there is a lot of roadwork underway in and around the City, I view it as a positive sign of Rockwall's growth and vitality. Some of the highpoints of current projects include:

SH 205 (SH 78 to US 80) - Evaluating environmental impacts and preliminary roadway schematics to widen SH 205.

FM 3097 Roadway Improvements (FM 740 beyond Tubbs Road) - Widening roadway from a two lane asphalt roadway to a four lane divided concrete roadway. Project estimated completion date is December 2017.

IH 30/FM 3549 Interchange - Reconstruction of the interchange of IH 30/FM 3549 to place IH 30 over FM 3549, improve eastbound and westbound frontage roads and improve FM 3549 to a four lane divided roadway at the Interchange. Project estimated completion date is Fall 2018.

IH 30 (Bass Pro Drive to West FM 2642) - Widen IH 30 to six main lanes west of SH 205 to FM 2642. Widen IH 30 to eight main lanes from Bass Pro Drive to west of SH 205. Construct three lane frontage roads in each direction from Bass Pro Drive to Horizon Road including bridge structures over Lake Ray Hubbard. This project is going through the environmental assessment/schematic phase at the present time. Estimated construction start is 2021.

I am extremely proud of our hometown and all that we are able to accomplish together. I encourage each citizen to get involved with one of the many volunteer opportunities within the City. If you are interested, get an application at City Hall or apply online at rockwall.com/boards. I would also like to hear from you. I have open office hours each Monday from noon to 4 p.m. at Rockwall City Hall, located at 385 South Goliad Street, or feel free to email me at jimpruitt@rockwall.com. I look forward to working with each of you to continue making Rockwall a great place to live, work and play.

Respectfully,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Jim Pruitt". The signature is fluid and cursive.

Jim Pruitt • Rockwall Mayor